

Middleware to Cloud Migration Checklist

A phased checklist for moving legacy middleware and integrations onto Azure without a risky all-at-once cutover. Work through each section in order before moving a single workload.

1. Dependency & environment audit

- ☐ Map every system that produces or consumes data through the middleware layer
- ☐ Identify undocumented or point-to-point integrations that bypass the middleware layer entirely
- ☐ Catalog authentication and connectivity requirements for each integration
- ☐ Document current message volumes and peak load windows

2. Downtime tolerance assessment

- ☐ Classify each integration by downtime tolerance: zero, minutes, or hours
- ☐ Identify integrations with hard SLAs or compliance requirements
- ☐ Flag integrations with no clear owner or unclear business criticality

3. Phased migration plan

- ☐ Group integrations into migration waves by risk and dependency
- ☐ Sequence waves so no wave breaks a system that hasn't migrated yet
- ☐ Define concrete success criteria for a wave before starting the next one

4. Rollback trigger -- defined in advance

- ☐ Set explicit, measurable rollback criteria before cutover, not decided under pressure
- ☐ Name who has the authority to call a rollback
- ☐ Keep the legacy path live and reachable until the new path is validated in production

5. Cutover & validation

- ☐ Run the new path against production traffic in parallel before full cutover
- ☐ Validate message parity -- volume, latency, error rate -- against the legacy baseline
- ☐ Confirm monitoring and alerting are live on the new path before legacy is retired

6. Post-migration

- ☐ Decommission the legacy path only after a defined stability window
- ☐ Document the as-built architecture of the new environment
- ☐ Stand up ongoing health, cost, and anomaly monitoring